WORLD HEALTH DAY

Stepping up to the Global Challenges

World Health Day is a global health awareness day celebrated on the 7th of April every year, under the patronage of the World Health Organization (WHO). WHO was formed in 1948 in Geneva. On this day, the World Health Assembly was held for the first time and it was decided to observe 7th April as World Health Day. In the year 1950, World Health Day was celebrated worldwide for the first time. World Health Day is one of eight official global health annual campaigns marked by WHO, along with World Tuberculosis Day, World Immunization Week, World Malaria Day, World No Tobacco Day, World AIDS Day, World Blood Donor Day, and World Hepatitis Day. Over the past 50 years, this has brought to light important health issues such as mental wellness, maternal and child care, and climate change. The celebration is marked by activities that extend beyond the day itself and serves as an opportunity to focus worldwide attention on these important aspects of global health.

Each year, there is a specific theme for World Health Day. The theme for World Health Day 2022 is "Our Planet, Our Health". This year's theme focuses on keeping humans and the planet healthy. It also aims to foster a movement to create a society focused on well-being. As per the WHO, every year, more than 13 billion deaths occur due to avoidable environmental causes. This consists of the climate crisis, which is the single biggest threat to health facing humanity. Therefore, the climate crisis is also a health crisis.

Global challenges to health and the environment include huge population, poverty, limited resources, food, and agricultural challenges among others. Any discussion of health must include consideration of the size of the population and its consumption level since this combination largely determines the impact that the human population makes on the environment. It must include the distribution of income and assets, the prime concern being for people whose health is impaired by lack of them. In developing countries, where populations are still expanding, pressure on scarce resources has made it difficult to improve living conditions. In developed countries, where population levels are largely static, prosperity has given rise to increased consumption and even overconsumption. Insufficient regard gets paid to the possible planetary impacts, the depletion of non-renewable resources, the degradation of soil and water resources, and the emission of gases that threaten climatic stability and the stratospheric ozone layer leave. Healthier environments and lower death rates are not inconsistent with the goal of reducing population growth rates. Indeed, the steps that reduce infant and child deaths also tend to encourage reduced fertility rates. They promote

A secure livelihood, better health and education for the mothers, and improved water supplies, sanitation, and nutrition, all coupled with effective family planning programs integrated into health care systems available to all. The most affected section of the population is women and children, with a higher vulnerability to environmental health risks. Within households it is generally women who look after the children, manage the household, and care for the sick; as such they suffer more from the diseases associated with inadequate water and sanitation and from the defects in the provision of basic services. Women who look after households also usually face discrimination in their hunt for jobs and in obtaining access to public services, housing, and credit. The ecological base for feeding the world's population is under stress owing to the rapid degradation of land and water resources. Production and distribution methods remain inefficient, as is shown by the size of the losses before and after harvesting. A continued rise in the population in a number of developing countries, greater substitution of meat, eggs and dairy products for grains and vegetables, and increased food and soil losses put great stress on farmers and the ecological underpinnings of farming systems. Conversely, reduced population growth, better-balanced diets, changes in production techniques, and greater attention to reducing food losses would make it possible for farmers to sustain production and meet future demands.

The world needs to work for better primary healthcare services to cover the majority of health needs throughout life, including services such as screening for health problems, vaccines, information on how to prevent disease, family planning, treatment for long- and short-term conditions, coordination with other levels of care, and rehabilitation. A health system with strong primary healthcare delivers better health outcomes, is cost-efficient, and improves the quality of care. Various agencies have been working hard to improve health infrastructure and fitness levels.

Good health provides better capabilities to work as per the requirements of the growing World and hence is very important. The World Health Organisation (WHO)'s foundation was laid on the principle that all humans realize their right to the highest possible levels of health. World Health Day is celebrated to highlight the importance of making our health a priority. We will be able to handle other aspects of our life efficiently only when we are healthy. It has been rightly said that a healthy brain resides in a healthy body.

